

1 HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION NO. 74

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6 A JOINT RESOLUTION OF THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE STATE OF
7 MONTANA REQUESTING AN INTERIM STUDY EXAMINING WATER REUSE; AND REQUIRING THAT THE
8 FINAL RESULTS OF THE STUDY BE REPORTED TO THE 70TH LEGISLATURE.
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10 WHEREAS, Montana's water resources are of exceptional quality and are a valuable resource to the
11 residents of the state; and

12 WHEREAS, water reuse, also known as water recycling, is a process in which wastewater is purified
13 for a designated beneficial freshwater purpose; and

14 WHEREAS, the potential uses of recycled water include agricultural, industrial, and municipal
15 purposes; and

16 WHEREAS, water reuse is a tool to promote sustainable and resilient water supplies and protect
17 environmentally sensitive resources; and

18 WHEREAS, there may exist technical, regulatory, financial, and educational roadblocks preventing the
19 implementation of water reuse programs in Montana; and

20 WHEREAS, individualizing levels of treatment for specific uses is more cost and energy efficient than a
21 standardized treatment approach; and

22 WHEREAS, opportunities for water reuse may be underexplored in Montana.
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24 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE AND THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF
25 THE STATE OF MONTANA:

26 That the Legislative Council be requested to designate an appropriate interim committee or statutory
27 committee, pursuant to section 5-5-217, MCA to:

28 (1) examine existing statutes and administrative rules related to water reuse;

- 1 (2) analyze existing reuse infrastructure, including the volume, timing, use, and availability of
2 reused water;
- 3 (3) examine how other states have implemented water reuse in the public and private sectors;
- 4 (4) analyze what industries, except agriculture, and geographic areas in the state currently
5 implement water reuse programs and what industries and geographic areas in the state may benefit from water
6 reuse programs;
- 7 (5) determine what legal, economic, and social barriers exist for industries and communities
8 attempting to implement water reuse programs;
- 9 (6) analyze what economic, environmental, and population factors necessitate the implementation
10 of water reuse programs; and
- 11 (7) if necessary, propose legislation to incentivize and facilitate water reuse programs in the state.
- 12 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that all aspects of the study, including presentation and review
13 requirements, be concluded prior to September 15, 2026.
- 14 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the final results of the study, including any findings, conclusions,
15 comments, or recommendations of the appropriate committee, be reported to the 70th Legislature.

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